Segue CRM: Accounting Practice Module

User Guide & Step-by-Step Practical Manual

Application URL	https://crm-segueit.vercel.app
Who it's for	Partners, Accountants (registered tax agent staff), Bookkeepers and Practice Administrators
Rules it supports	APES 305 (Terms of Engagement), Tax Practitioners Board proof-of-identity guidance, ATO client-to-agent linking, independent review before lodgement, SMSF auditor independence

> **Important**
> The system helps you follow these rules, but the practice remains responsible for compliance. The default lodgement due dates are a starting point: confirm them against your tax agent lodgment program.

1. Introduction to the Accounting Practice Module

The Accounting Practice module runs a practice's client work:

- client entities with their tax details;
- **engagements** (tax returns, BAS, IAS, FBT, SMSF work, bookkeeping, payroll and advisory);
- APES 305 engagement letters the client signs online;
- document requests the client answers in the portal;
- ATO lodgement deadlines, with reminders;
- time recording with WIP and recoverability, and invoicing.

It enforces the key steps:

- no work starts before the engagement letter is signed;
- a second person reviews before anything is lodged;
- only registered tax agent staff lodge;
- the client's identity is verified (and a business has nominated the practice as its agent) before lodging.

Roles in your practice

Profile	What they can do
Partner	Every client, engagement, letter, deadline, document request, time entry and invoice. Lodges returns (*Lodge Returns*), signs off reviews, and records paper-signed letters. Invites clients to the portal, imports, exports and transfers records.

Profile	What they can do
Accountant	Prepares and lodges their own engagements (*Lodge Returns*): letters, document requests, deadlines, time and invoices. Invites clients to the portal.
Bookkeeper	Bookkeeping and BAS preparation on engagements shared with them: document requests, deadlines and time. Can't lodge.
Practice Administrator	Client onboarding: clients and contact people, new engagements, engagement letters, deadlines and document requests. Reads all time. Invites clients to the portal.
System Administrator	The person who created the workspace. Everything, plus Setup.

The Responsible Accountant and Reviewer on an engagement, and the Client Manager on a client, automatically get access to it.

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2. Getting Started & Interface Tour

Step 1: Sign in

1. Go to **https://crm-segueit.vercel.app**.
2. Enter your **Work e-mail** and **Password**, then click **Sign in**.
3. The first time you sign in, you set up **two-step verification** with an authenticator app. After that you enter its 6-digit code each time.

Record each registered tax agent's **Tax agent number** on their user record (Setup → Users). It appears on the engagement letters they send.

Step 2: The sidebar

Your workspace opens in the **Accounting Practice** app. The sidebar lists:

- **Home:** shortcuts, Lodgements Due, My Engagements, your tasks and the Practice Dashboard charts.
- **Prospects:** potential clients. Convert a prospect to create the client.
- **Clients:** the entities you act for (individuals, companies, trusts, partnerships, SMSFs).
- **Contact People:** the people you deal with at each client.
- **Engagements**, **Lodgement Deadlines**, **Time Entries** and **Invoices**.
- **Client Requests:** questions and requests clients send from the portal.
- **Calendar, Reports and Dashboards.**
- **Setup** (at the bottom, for administrators).

Engagement letters and document requests live inside each engagement (its **Related** tab). Collapse the sidebar with the arrow at its top or **Ctrl+B**. Every page except Home has a **Back** button.

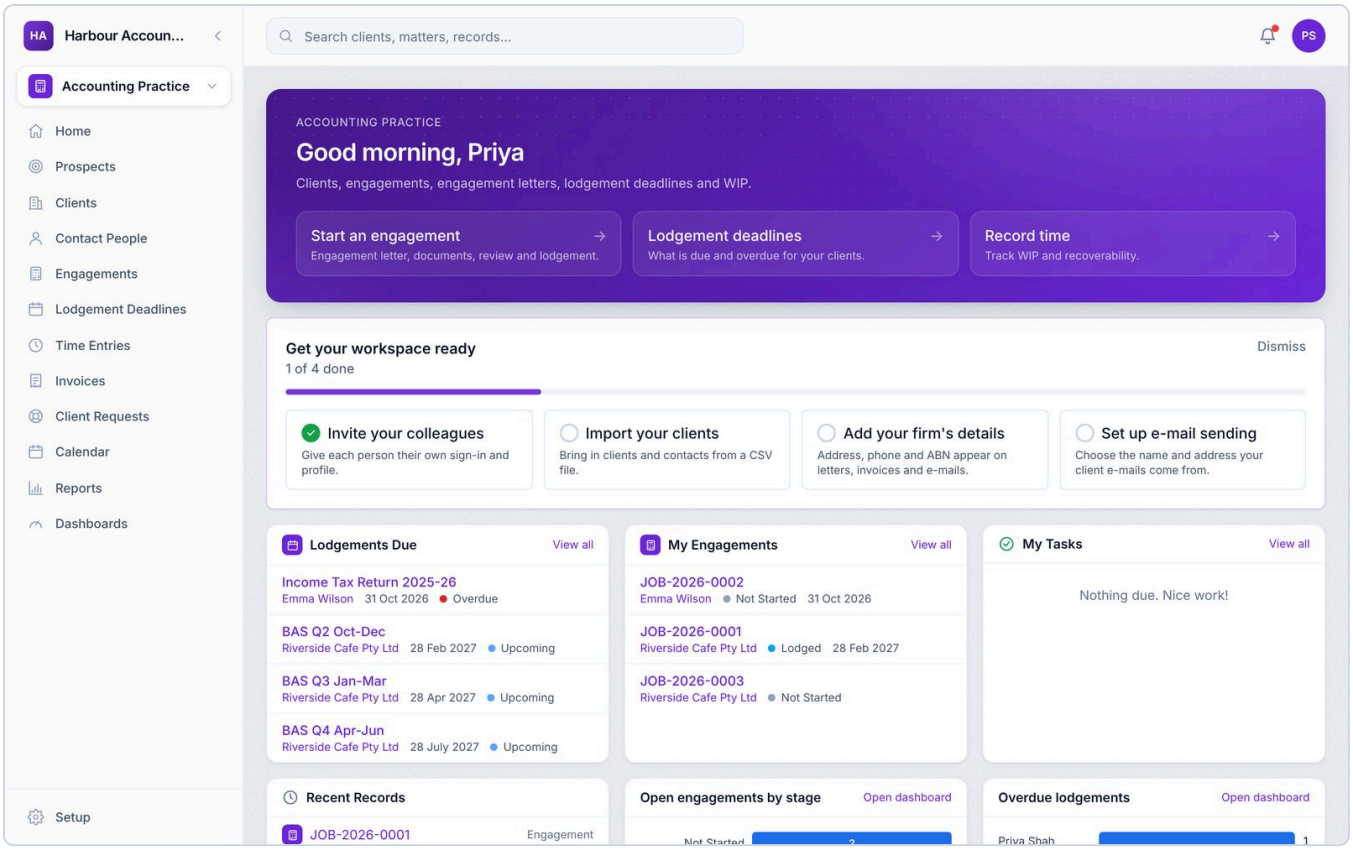


Figure 1: Home, with the Start an engagement, Lodgement deadlines and Record time shortcuts, Lodgements Due and My Engagements.

3. Clients

In this module a **client** is the entity you act for. The people at that client are **contact people**. A client's **Tax and Entity** section holds:

- **Entity Type:** Individual, Sole Trader, Company, Trust, Partnership, SMSF or Not-for-profit.
- **ABN** and **Tax File Number:** both are checked against the ATO check digits, so a typo is caught before it reaches a lodgement. The TFN is stored encrypted and visible only to Partners, Accountants, Practice Administrators and administrators.
- **Registered for GST**, **BAS Frequency** (Monthly, Quarterly, Annually or Not Registered) and **Financial Year End** (normally 30-06).
- **Client Manager:** they get full access to the client's file.
- **Identity Verified** and **Identity Verified On:** proof of identity sighted (TPB and ATO requirements).
- **Agent Nominated (Client-to-Agent Linking):** tick it once a business client has nominated the practice in ATO Online services for business.

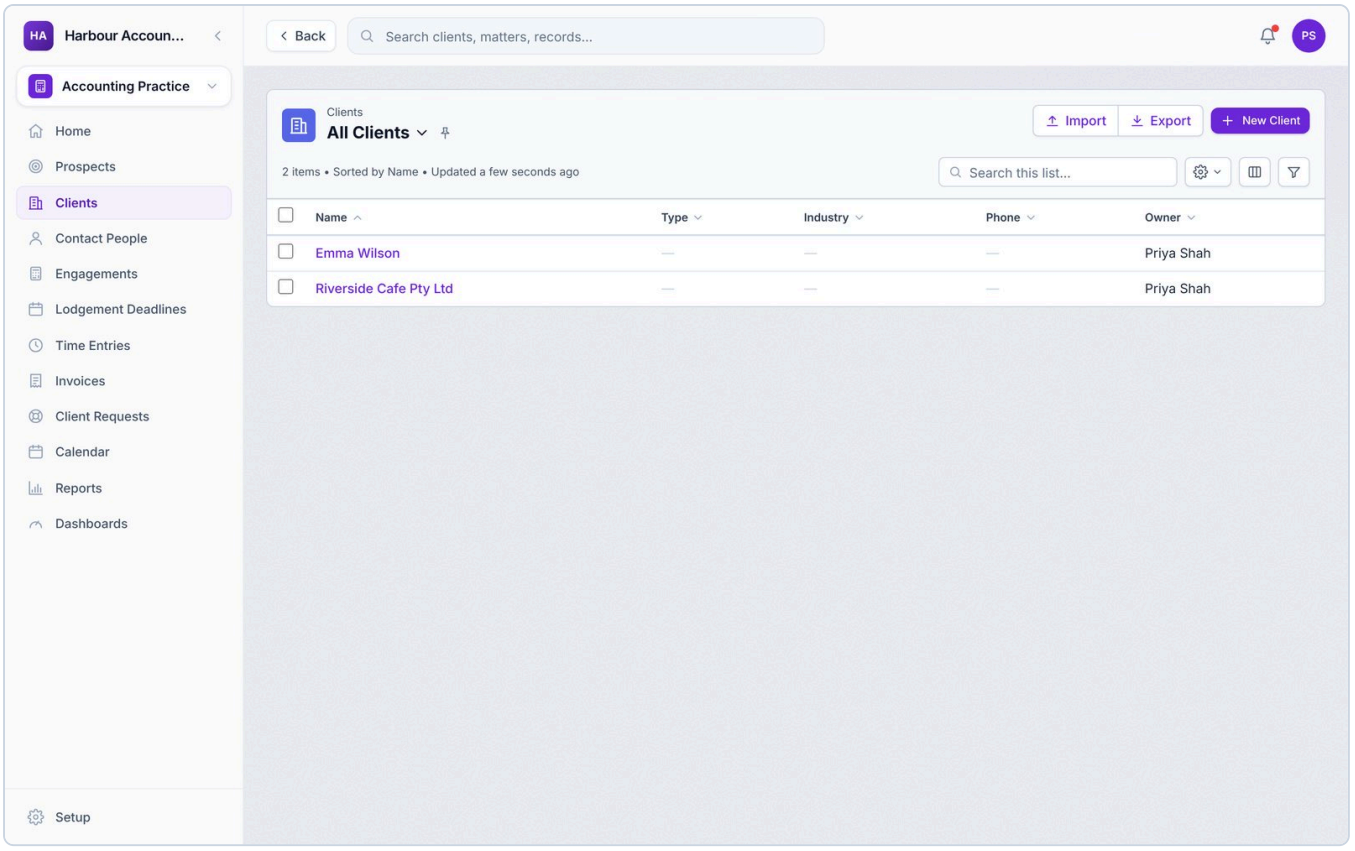


Figure 2: The Clients list.

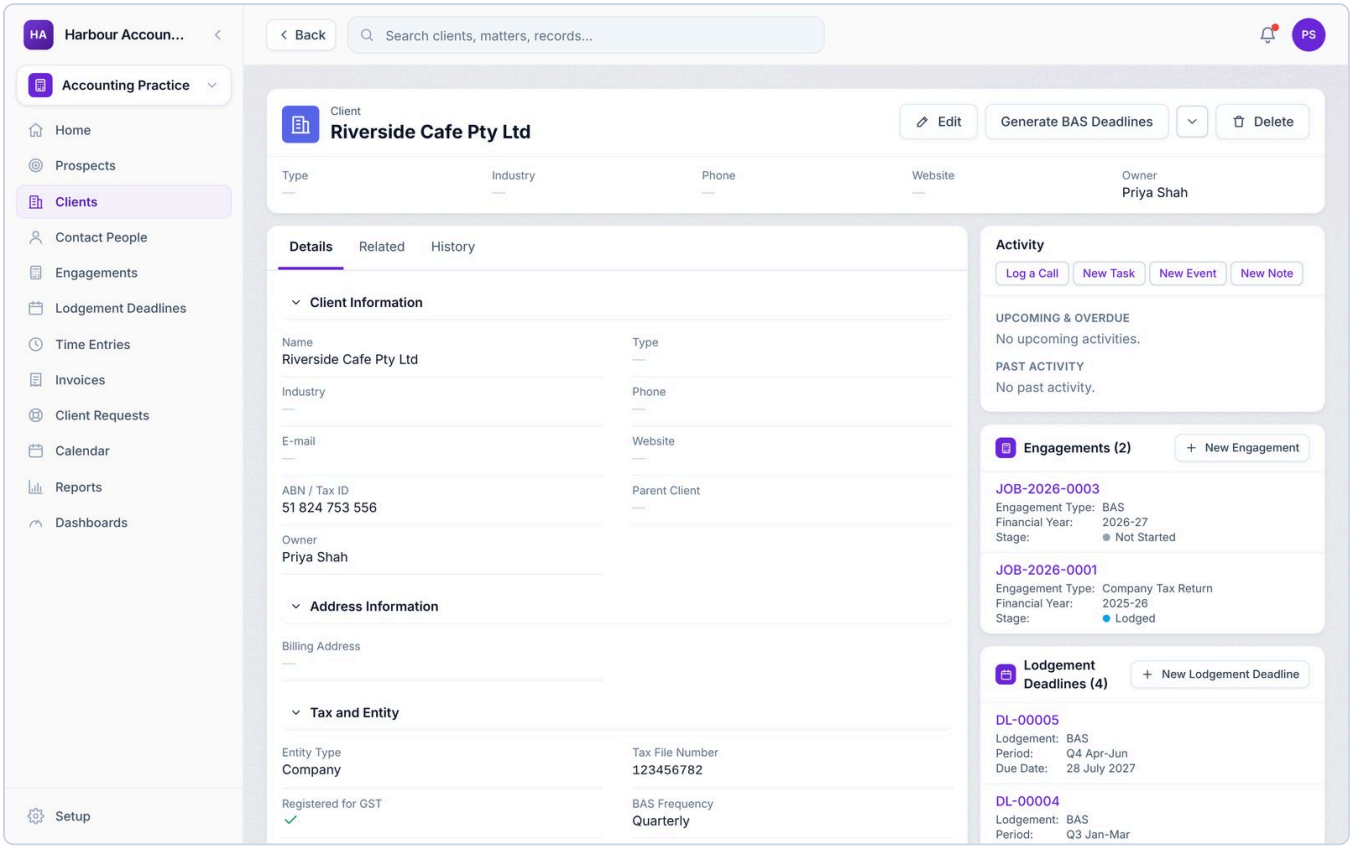


Figure 3: A company client with its tax and entity details, engagements and lodgement deadlines.

Generating BAS deadlines

On a client with a BAS Frequency, click **Generate BAS Deadlines**. The app creates the activity statement deadlines for the current financial year, skipping periods already created and dates already past, and assigns them to the Client Manager.

The due dates follow the **BAS due dates** setting:

- **Standard ATO dates**;
- or the **registered agent lodgment program** (for example, quarterly: Q1 25 November, Q3 26 May, Q4 25 August).

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4. Engagements

Viewing engagements

Open **Engagements**. The table shows Job Number, Client, Engagement Type, Financial Year, Stage, Lodgement Due and Responsible Accountant. Switch to the **board view** with the buttons beside the search box. The views are:

- **All Engagements**
- **My Engagements**
- **Open Engagements:** by due date.
- **Awaiting Review**

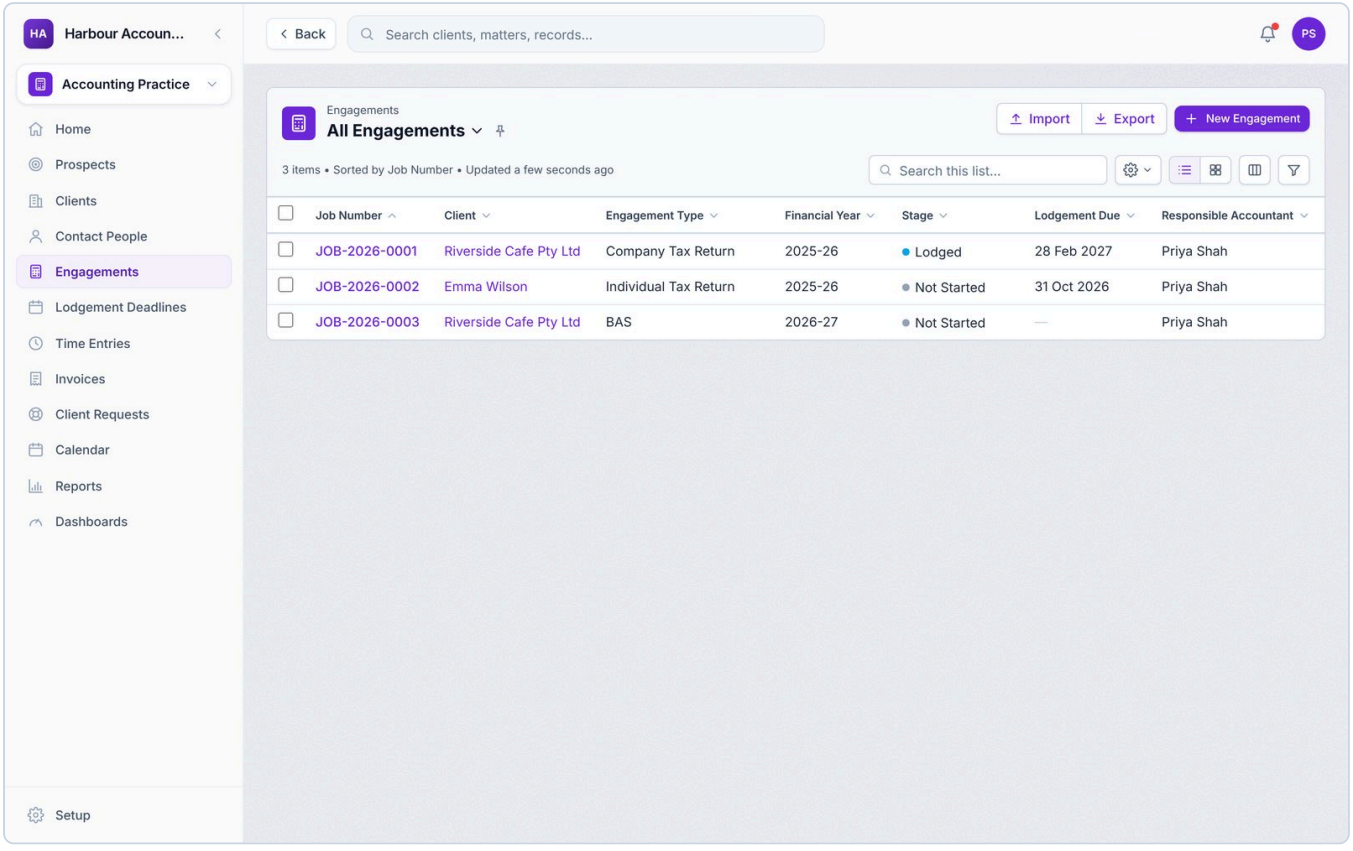


Figure 4: The Engagements list.

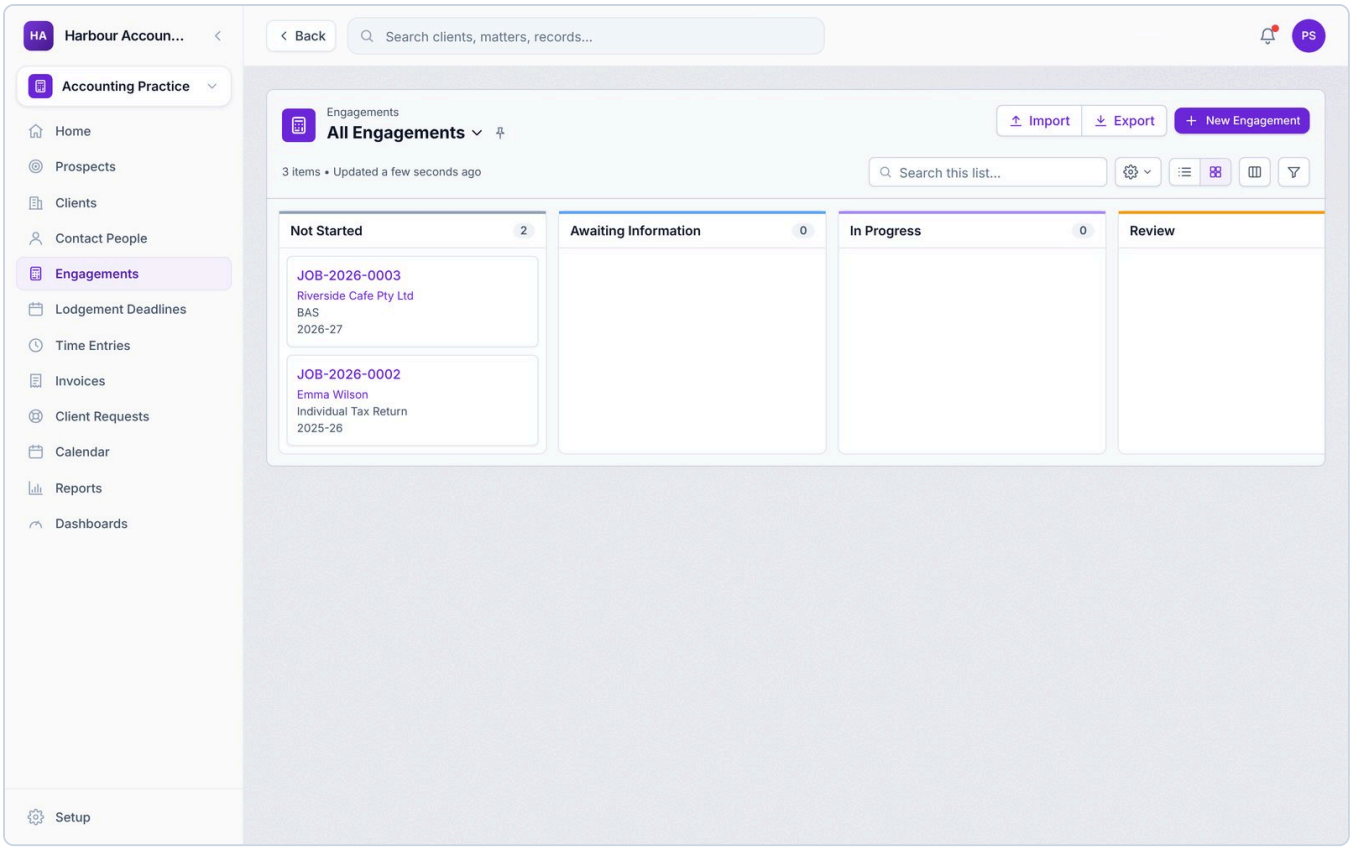


Figure 5: Engagements in board view.

Step by step: starting an engagement

1. Click **Start an engagement** on Home, or **+ New Engagement**.
2. Choose the **Client** (required) and optionally the **Client Contact Person**.
3. Choose the **Engagement Type** (required): Individual, Company, Trust or Partnership Tax Return; SMSF Annual Return; BAS; IAS; FBT Return; SMSF Audit; Bookkeeping; Payroll; or Advisory.
4. **Financial Year:** leave it empty and the app fills it in. Returns and audits get the last completed year (for example 2025-26); FBT gets the last FBT year (April to March); other work gets the current year. For BAS and IAS, enter the **Period** (for example "Q2 Oct-Dec").
5. **Lodgement Due:** leave it empty to use the practice's default for the return type:
   - Individual: 31 October;
   - Company and SMSF: 28 February;
   - Trust and Partnership: 31 March;
   - FBT: 21 May.

   These can be changed in Practice Settings.
6. **Responsible Accountant:** leave empty to make it you. Choose a **Reviewer** (someone else).
7. Under **Fees**, choose Fixed Fee (and the Agreed Fee) or Time-based.
8. Save. The engagement gets the next number (for example **JOB-2026-0001**) and starts at **Not Started**.

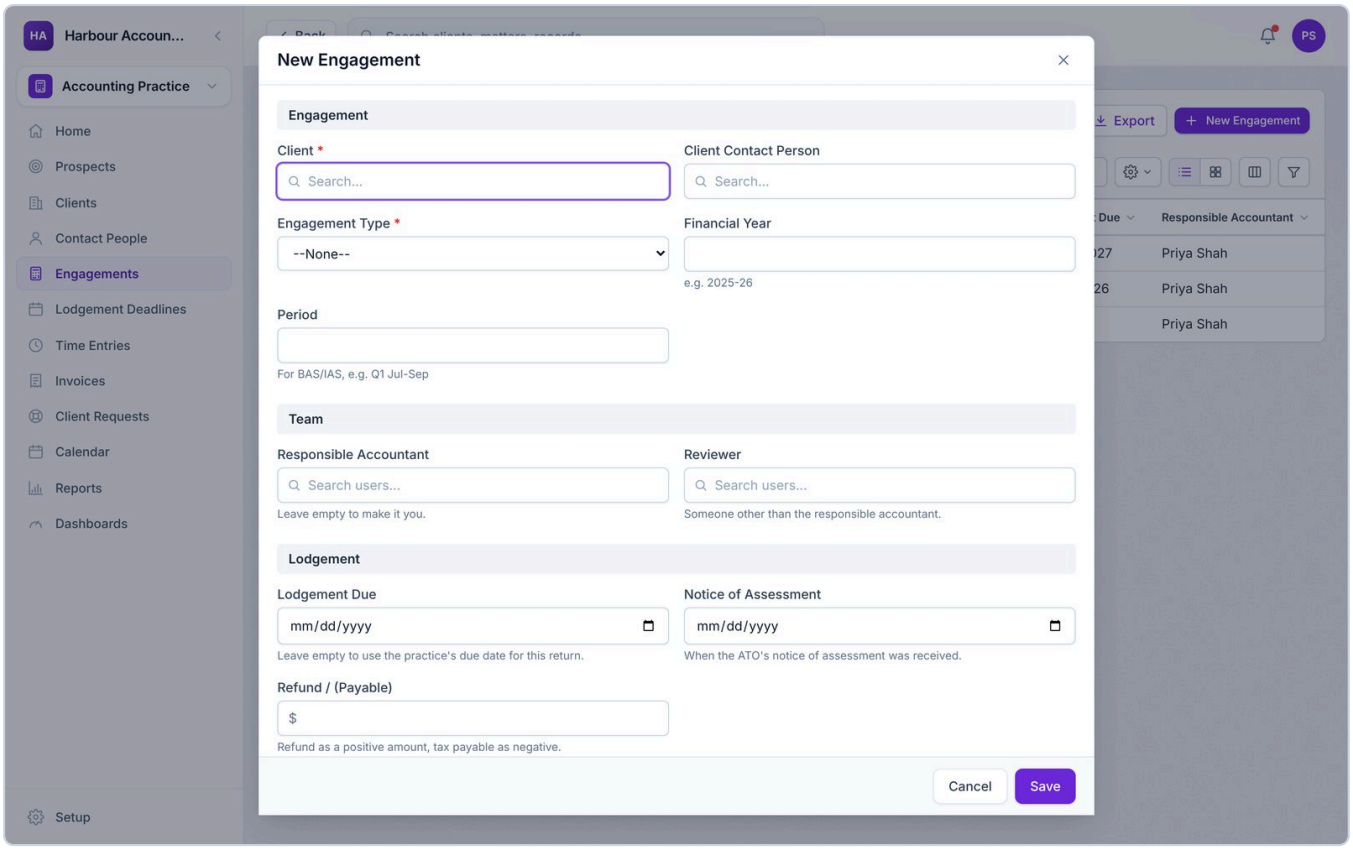


Figure 6: The New Engagement form.

Created for you

- **Document requests:**
  a standard list for the engagement type, visible to the client. For example, an individual return asks for income statements, interest and dividend statements, deduction receipts, the private health statement and rental income and expenses.
- **Lodgement deadline:**
  for returns, BAS, IAS and FBT, linked to the engagement. It follows the engagement's due date and responsible accountant.

Engagement stages

1. Not Started
New engagements start here

2. Awaiting Information
Set automatically when the letter is signed

3. In Progress
Needs the signed letter. Set automatically when every document request is in

4. Review

5. Ready to Lodge
Needs a different reviewer, who signs it off (or a partner)

6. Lodged
Needs Lodge Returns, ID verified and, for a business, agent nominated

7. Complete

To move to	The app requires
In Progress (or later)	**Engagement Letter Signed**, when "Engagement letter before work starts (APES 305)" is on in Practice Settings (it is by default)
Ready to Lodge (or later)	A **Reviewer** who isn't the Responsible Accountant. Only the reviewer, or a partner, can make this move.
Lodged or Complete (returns, BAS, IAS, FBT)	• The **Lodge Returns** permission (Partner, Accountant). • The client's **Identity Verified** ticked. • For a client that isn't an individual or sole trader: **Agent Nominated** ticked. Sets the **Lodged** date and marks the engagement's lodgement deadlines as Lodged.

The engagement moves on by itself at two points:

- **Not Started → Awaiting Information** when the letter is signed.
- **Awaiting Information → In Progress** once every document request is **Accepted** or **Not Applicable**. Engagements with no document requests move straight on.

For an **SMSF Audit**, the app refuses an auditor (responsible accountant or reviewer) who prepared the same fund's return or bookkeeping for that year: the auditor must be independent.

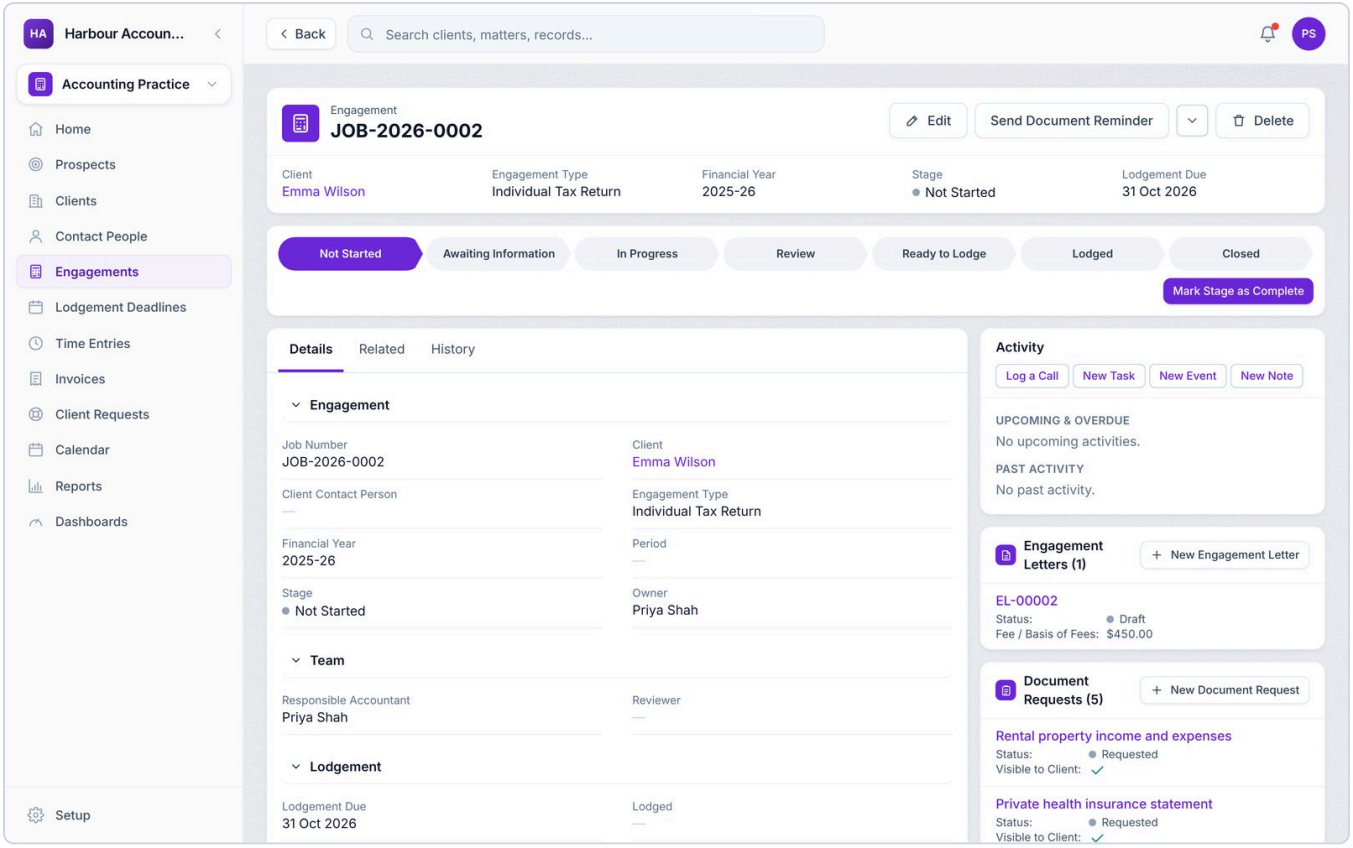


Figure 7: A new engagement at Not Started, with its stage path.

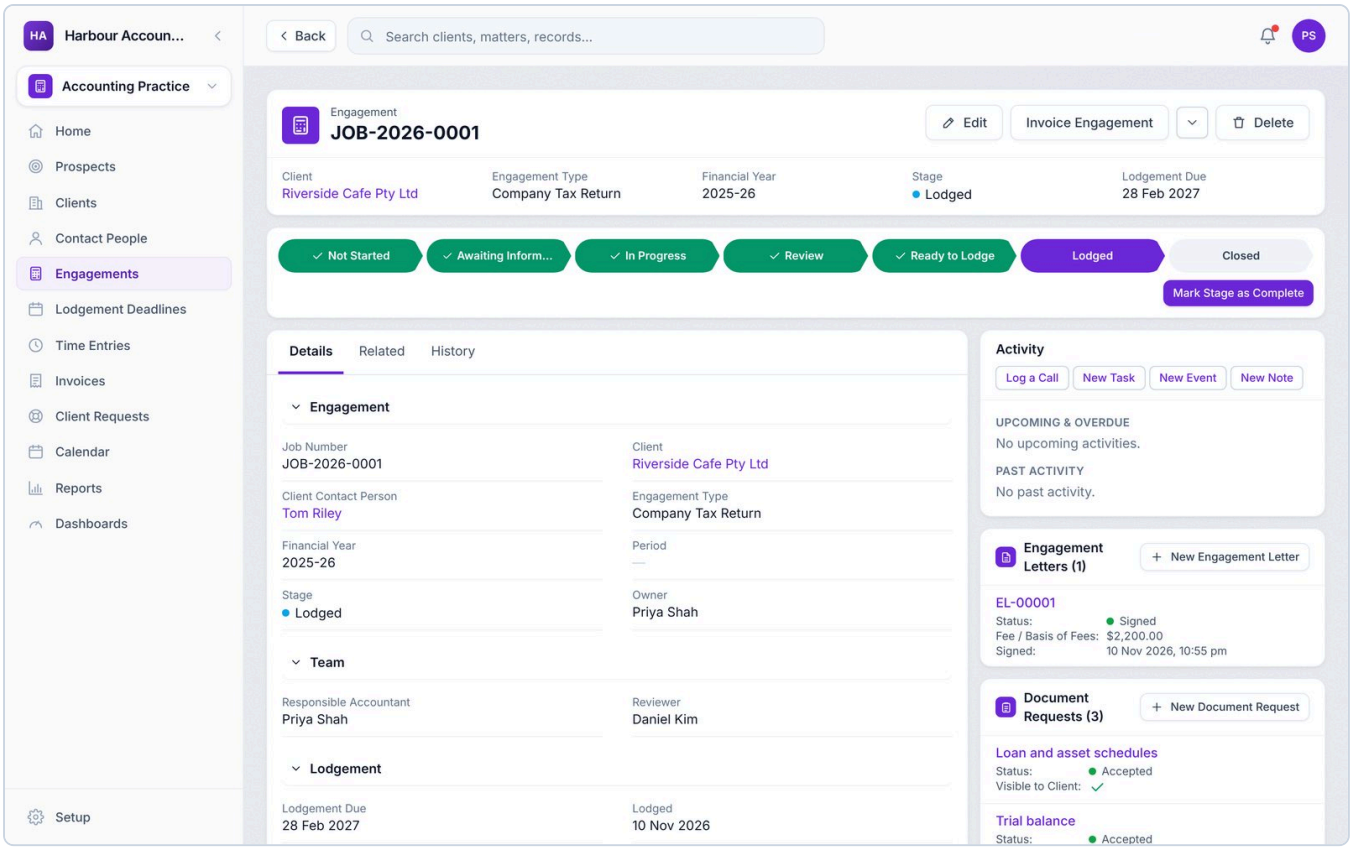


Figure 8: A lodged engagement: reviewed by a second person, with Invoice Engagement in the header.

After lodging, record the **ATO Lodgement Reference**. When the notice of assessment arrives, record its date and the **Refund / (Payable)** amount (refunds positive, tax payable negative).

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5. Engagement Letters (APES 305)

Step by step: sending the letter for signature

1. On the engagement's **Related** tab, click **+ New Engagement Letter**. Write the **Scope and Responsibilities** (required) and the client's responsibilities. The **Fee / Basis of Fees** defaults to the engagement's agreed fee. Save; the letter gets a number like **EL-00001**.
2. Click **Send to Client**. The letter records the **Tax Practitioner** (the responsible accountant) and their **Tax Agent Number**, or the practice's number from Practice Settings if they don't have one.
3. The client is e-mailed a link to read and sign the letter in their portal. If nobody at the client has portal access yet, you're notified to invite them.
4. The client signs by typing their full name and accepting the terms. The time and their IP address are recorded, the engagement's **Engagement Letter Signed** is ticked, and it moves to Awaiting Information.

If the letter was signed on paper, a **Partner** can choose **Record Paper Signature**, entering who signed it and where the signed copy is kept. This is recorded in the audit log. Signed and cancelled letters can't be changed.

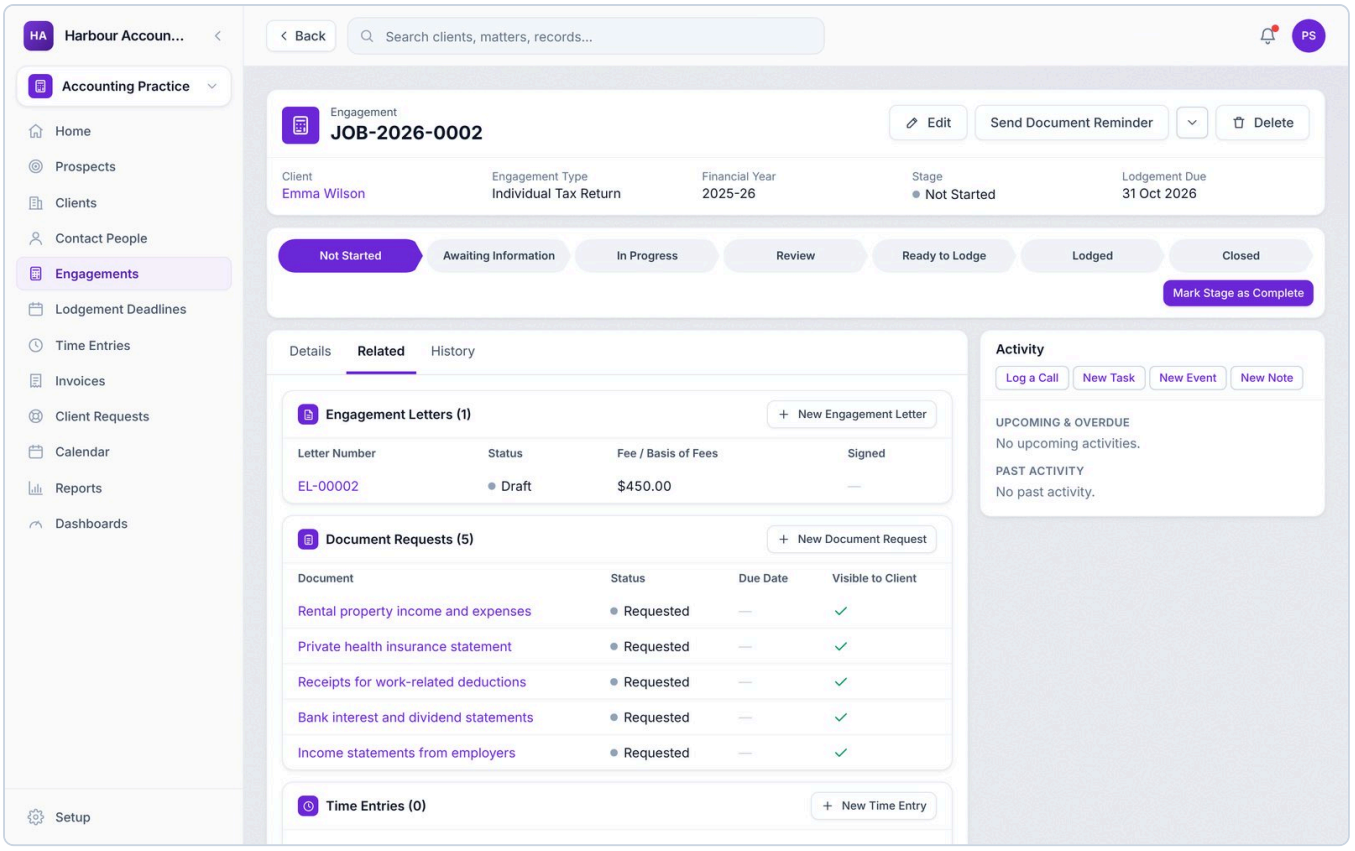


Figure 9: An engagement's Related tab: the draft letter and the document requests created for an individual return.

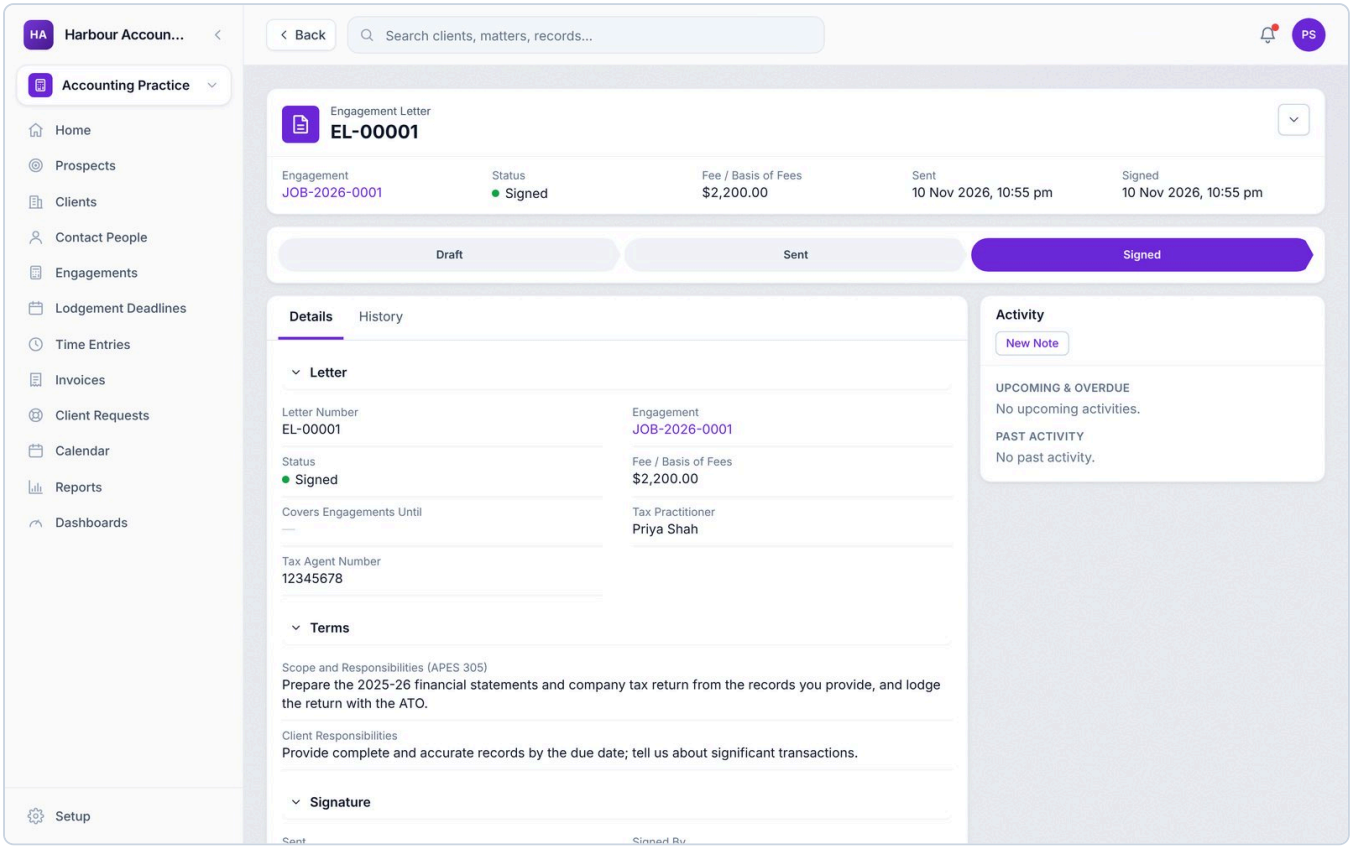


Figure 10: A signed engagement letter with the practitioner and tax agent number.

6. Document Requests

Each document request has a **Status** (Requested, Uploaded, Accepted or Not Applicable), a **Due Date**, **Instructions** and **Visible to Client**. Add more on the engagement's Related tab.

- **The client uploads:** in the portal, the client uploads the file on the request and presses **I've Uploaded This**. The request becomes **Uploaded** and the responsible accountant is notified.
- **You check it:** mark the request **Accepted**, or **Not Applicable**. When the last one is in, the engagement moves to In Progress.
- **Chasing: Send Document Reminder** on the engagement e-mails the client a list of everything still outstanding, with a link to the portal.

7. Lodgement Deadlines

Lodgement Deadlines lists every due date across your clients. Each deadline has:

- a **Lodgement** type: BAS, IAS, Income Tax Return, FBT Return, SMSF Annual Return, TPAR, Payroll Tax or Super Guarantee;
- the Period and **Due Date**;
- a **Status**: Upcoming, Overdue, Lodged or Deferred;
- the **Responsible** person.

The **Upcoming and Overdue** view sorts them by due date.

- **Overdue:** a deadline turns **Overdue** automatically the day after its due date.
- **Reminders:** the responsible person is notified 14 days, 3 days and on the day it's due (changeable in Practice Settings), until it's lodged.
- **Lodged:** marking a deadline Lodged fills in **Lodged On**. Lodging the engagement does this for its deadlines.

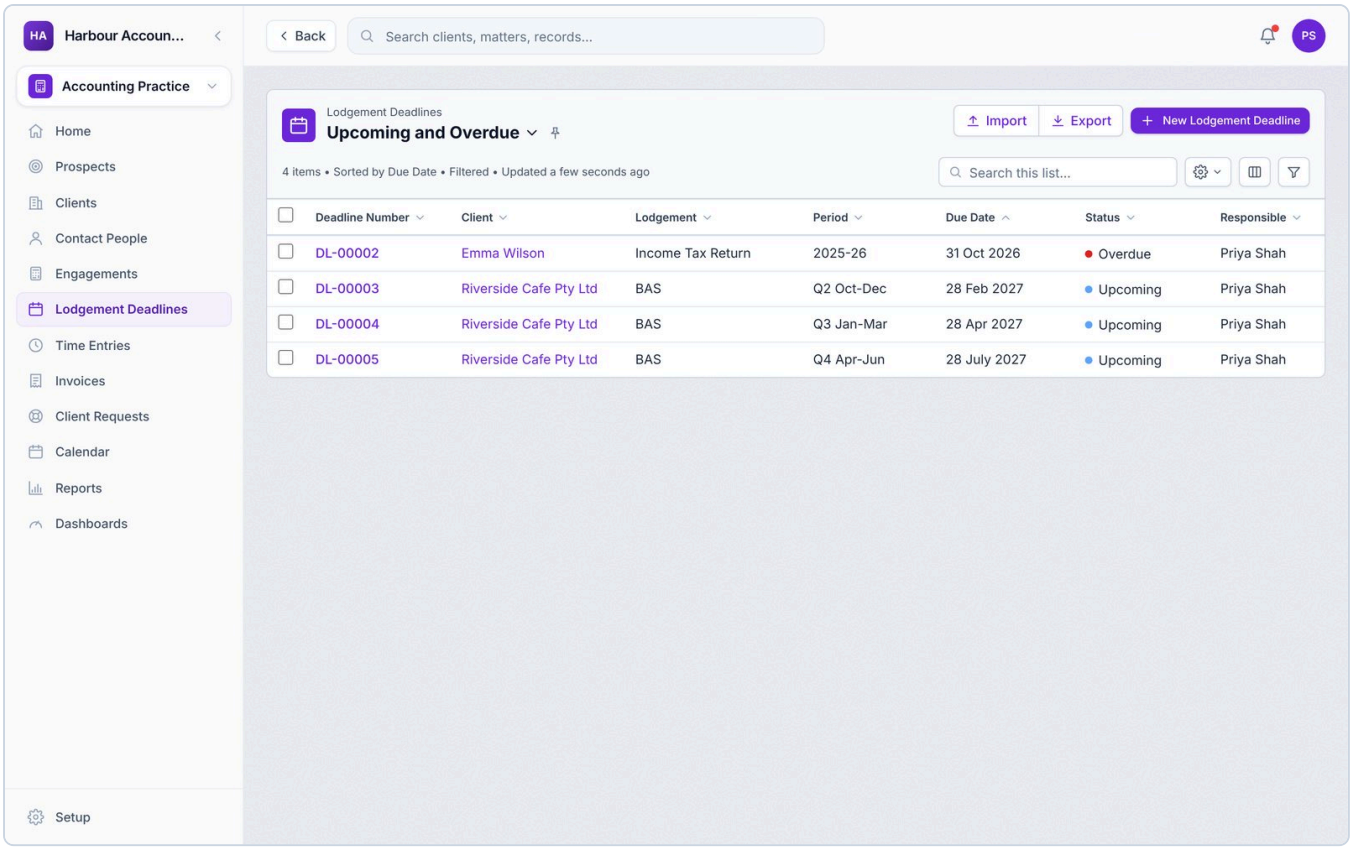


Figure 11: Upcoming and overdue deadlines, including generated BAS deadlines and an overdue individual return.

8. Time, WIP & Invoicing

Recording time

1. Click **Record time** on Home, or **+ New Time Entry**.
2. Choose the **Engagement** and **Date**. The **Staff Member** defaults to you.
3. Enter **Units (6 min)** (1 unit = 6 minutes) and describe the **Work Done** (required).
4. Leave the **Charge-out Rate** empty to use the practice default ($220 unless changed). Untick Billable for non-chargeable time.

The app calculates Hours and Amount (ex GST), numbers the entry (**TS-000001**), and updates the engagement's figures:

- **Time Cost:** all time except written-off;
- **Unbilled Time (WIP)**;
- **Recoverability:** the agreed fee as a percentage of time cost.

Billed or written-off time can't be changed. The **My Timesheet** view lists your entries.

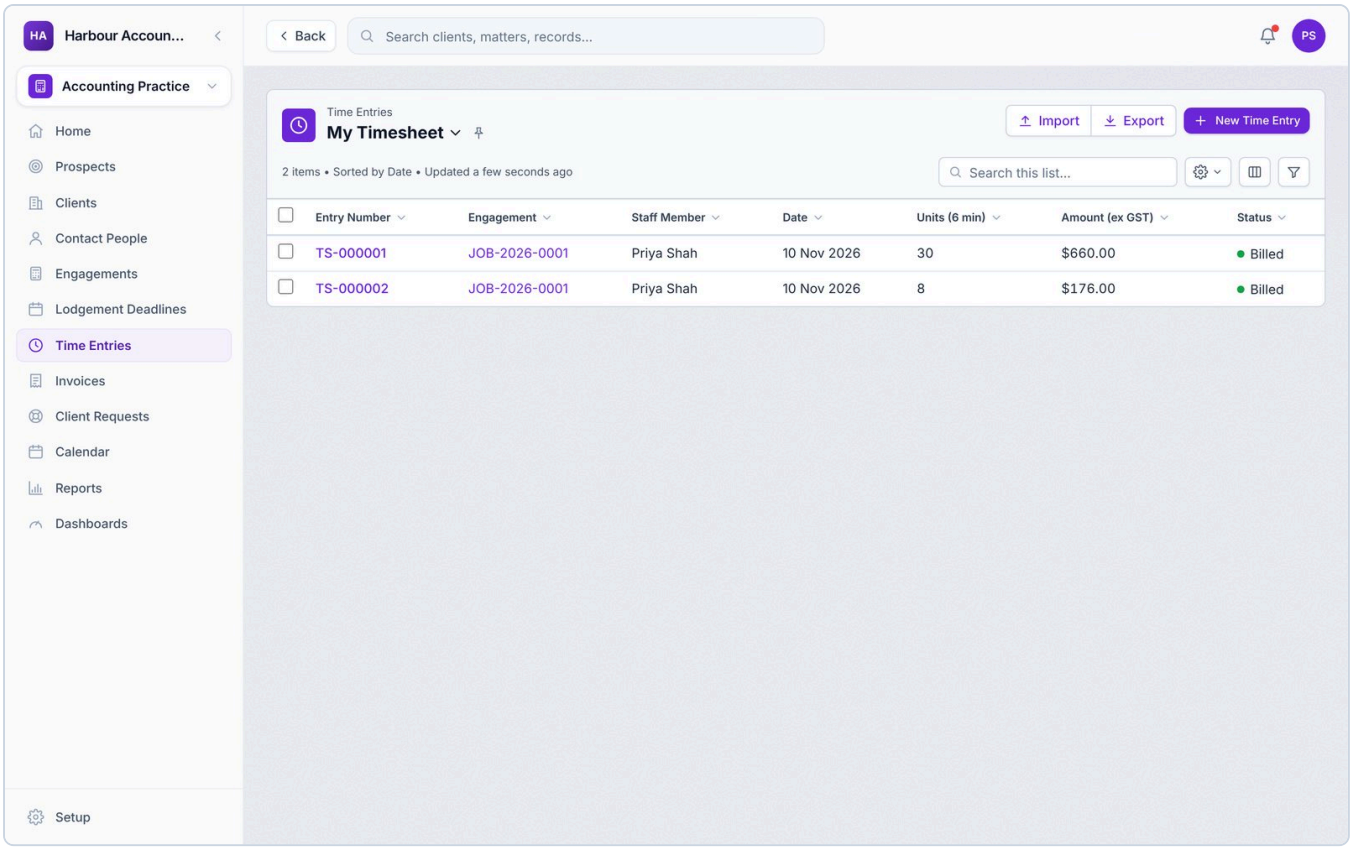


Figure 12: My Timesheet, with time billed through the engagement's invoice.

Invoicing an engagement

From In Progress onwards, click **Invoice Engagement**:

- **Fixed Fee:** one line for the agreed fee. The recorded time is absorbed and marked Billed. A fixed fee can be invoiced only once.
- **Time-based:** one line per unbilled billable time entry.

Review the draft invoice, then click **Issue Invoice**. Before issuing tax invoices, an administrator must add the practice's **ABN** in Setup → Company & Branding.

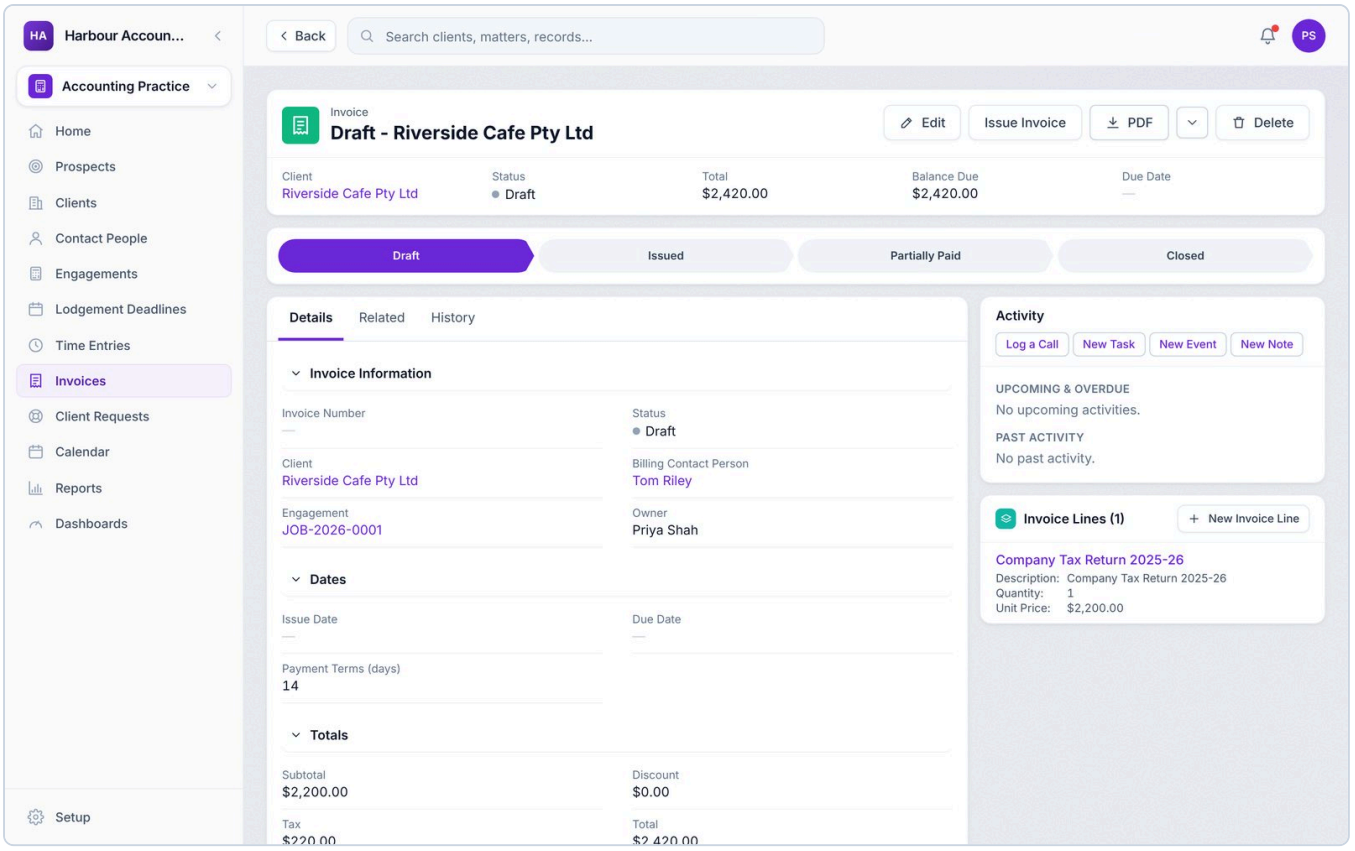


Figure 13: A draft invoice for an engagement's agreed fee, ready to issue.

9. The Client Portal

Give a client's contact person portal access from their record (▾ menu → **Invite to Client Portal**). In the portal they can:

- see their engagements (type, year, stage and due date; the reviewer, time cost, WIP, recoverability and scope notes stay hidden);
- sign engagement letters;
- upload requested documents;
- view their invoices;
- send requests, which appear under **Client Requests** and notify staff.

10. Reports & Dashboards

The **Practice Dashboard** (also on Home) shows open engagements by stage, overdue lodgements, workload by accountant, work in progress and upcoming lodgement deadlines.

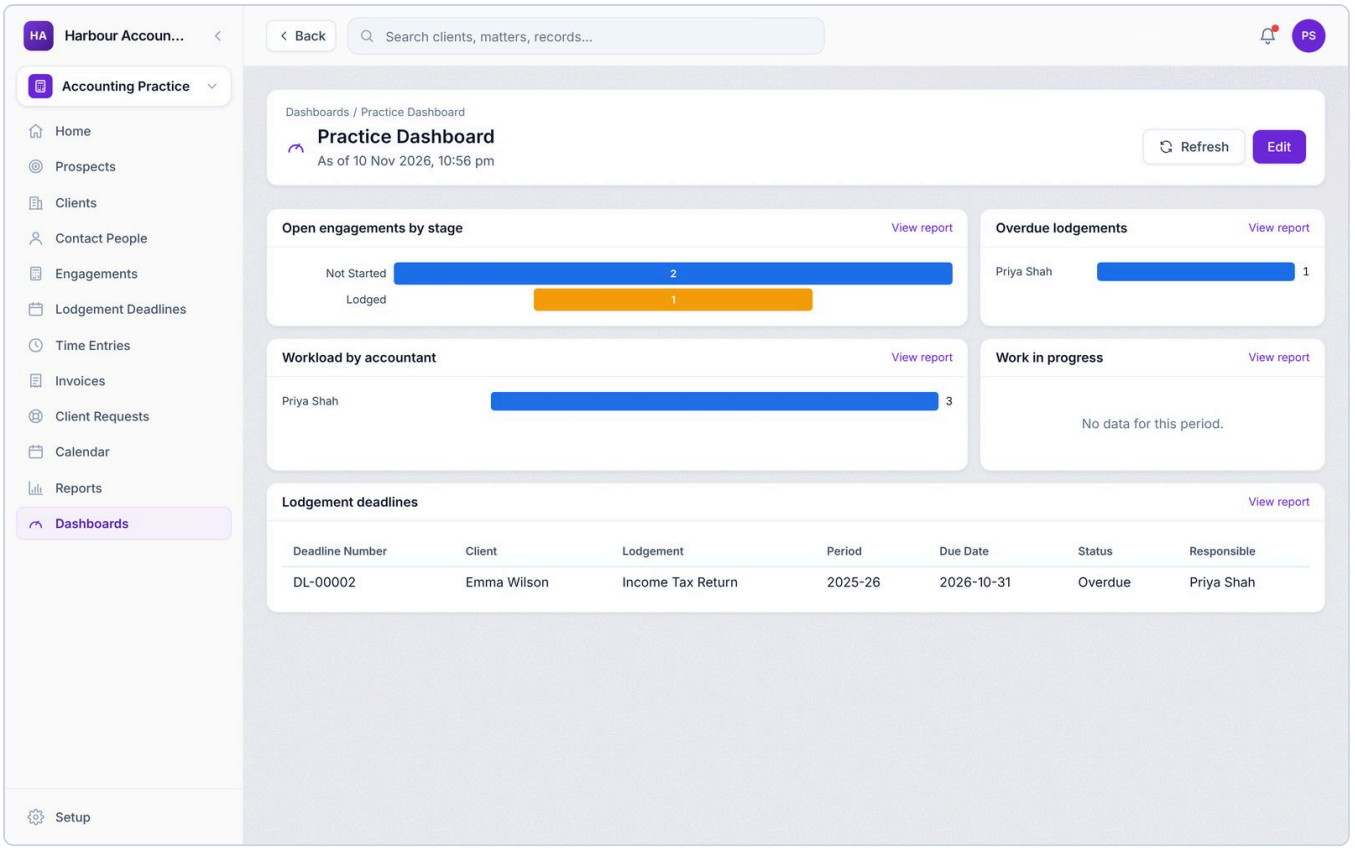


Figure 14: The Practice Dashboard.

The **Accounting Practice Reports** folder contains:

Report	What it shows
Open Engagements by Stage	Engagements not yet complete, per stage
Engagements by Type	Open engagements per engagement type
Workload by Accountant	Open engagements per responsible accountant
Work in Progress (Unbilled Time)	Unbilled billable time by engagement: amount and hours
Recoverability by Engagement	Agreed fee against time cost, lowest recoverability first
Lodgement Deadlines (next 30 days)	Upcoming and overdue deadlines due in the next 30 days
Overdue Lodgements	Overdue deadlines per responsible person

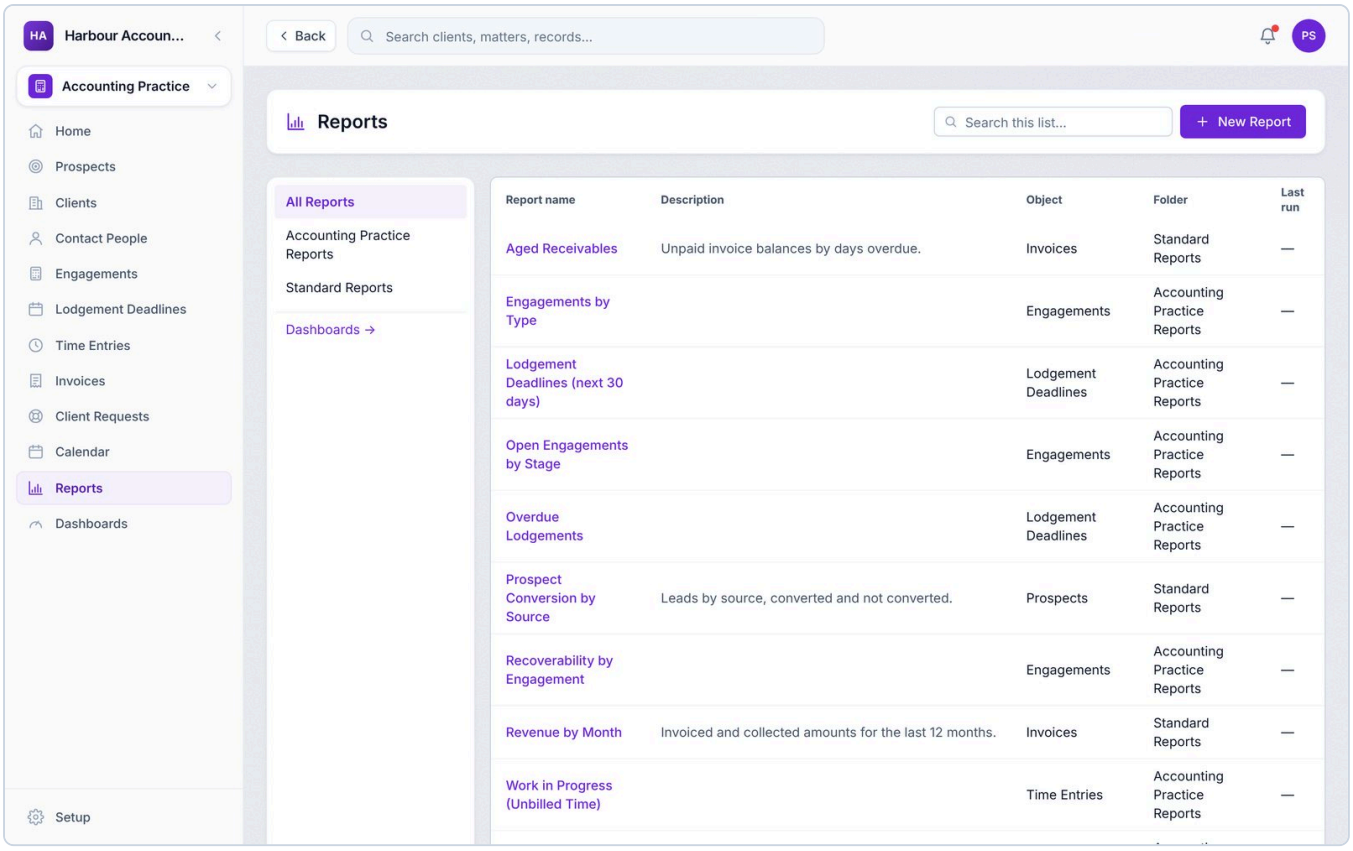


Figure 15: The Reports list.

11. Practice Settings

An administrator sets these in **Setup → Practice Settings → Accounting Practice (Australia)**:

Setting	Default
Practice tax agent number	Empty: shown on letters when the practitioner has no number of their own
Default charge-out rate	$220
Engagement letter before work starts (APES 305)	On
BAS due dates	Standard ATO dates (or the registered agent lodgment program)
Lodgement deadline reminders	14, 3 and 0 days before
Return due dates (DD-MM after the year ends)	Individual 31-10; Company 28-02; Trust 31-03; Partnership 31-03; SMSF 28-02; FBT 21-05

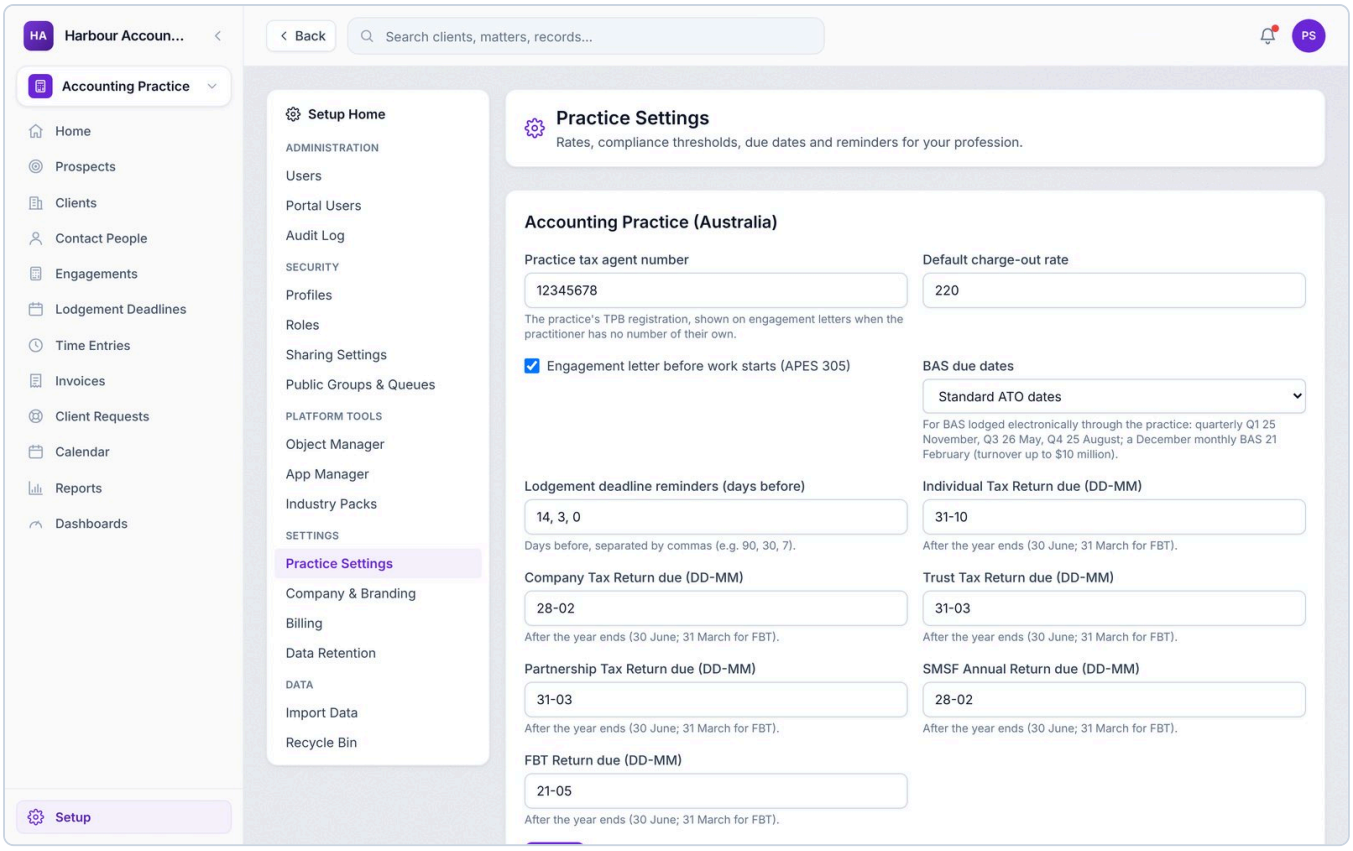


Figure 16: Practice Settings for the Accounting Practice module.

12. Audit Trail

- **History:** each record's **History** tab shows changes to key fields (client, stage, team, due date, letter signed, identity verified, agent nominated, document status) with who made them and when.
- **Audit log: Setup → Audit Log** records sign-ins, changes, letters sent and signed (including paper signatures), document reminders, exports and other actions, with the user, time and IP address.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1: Why can't I move an engagement to In Progress?

The engagement letter hasn't been signed. Send it to the client, or have a partner record a paper signature. Once it's signed and every document request is accepted, the engagement moves to In Progress by itself.

Q2: Why can't I move to Ready to Lodge?

Assign a Reviewer who isn't the Responsible Accountant. The reviewer (or a partner) then moves it, which records that the review was done by a second person.

Q3: Why can't I lodge?

Check three things:

- you have the Lodge Returns permission (Partner or Accountant);
- the client's Identity Verified is ticked;
- for a company, trust, partnership, SMSF or not-for-profit, Agent Nominated is ticked.

Q4: Sending the engagement letter says there's no tax agent number.

Add the responsible accountant's tax agent number in Setup → Users, or the practice's number in Practice Settings.

Q5: The client says they uploaded a document but nothing changed.

Ask them to press **I've Uploaded This** on the request in the portal. Or open the request yourself and set its status once you've checked the file.

Q6: The app won't let me save the TFN or ABN.

The number failed the ATO check-digit test. Check the digits with the client.

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14. Best Practice Summary

Phase	Best practice
Onboarding	Verify identity, record the entity's ABN and TFN, set the BAS frequency and client manager, and ask business clients to nominate the practice in ATO Online services.
Engagement	Send the engagement letter straight away, and trim the document requests to what you actually need.
Preparation	Record time daily and watch recoverability on fixed-fee work.
Review and lodgement	Have a second person review every return; record the ATO reference after lodging, and the notice of assessment when it arrives.
Deadlines	Generate BAS deadlines each financial year and check the Upcoming and Overdue view weekly.